Academic policy questions

Status: open. The system holds no approved answer to any of these questions. Each needs an institutional decision before faculty judgments can become approved evaluation references.

These seven questions arose while the syllabus-checking software was being evaluated. They are set out without saying how the software, or anyone else, answered the cases.

- **How to answer.** The policy panel records one decision per question in the record under it, or in `decision-and-approval-record.csv`, with the approving role, the approval reference and the date. Please decide on academic grounds. Do not choose an option because it would make the software agree with any particular answer.
- **The options are listed in no order of preference.** None is recommended. Option D lets the panel write its own.
- **Evidence notes.** Where the system holds something relevant, it is quoted as evidence of current practice, with its status as defined in the references (04-curriculum-and-institutional-references). It is not policy, and no text in this package has been confirmed by the institution. Where nothing is held, the question says so.
- **When to answer.** After the case reviewers have returned Part A (procedure, step 4), so that their own readings are recorded first.

P1. When is a CLO aligned with the program outcome it is mapped to: when it develops part of the PO, or only when it addresses all of it?

Two different judgments can be made about a program outcome: whether one CLO aligns with the PO it is mapped to, and whether the program, across all its courses, develops the whole PO. This question concerns the first. The second can be checked separately whichever option is chosen.

Option	What it says	What it would mean in practice
A. Contribution	A CLO is aligned with a PO when it develops a substantial part of the PO at an appropriate level. "Partially aligned" is kept for a contribution that is weak, indirect or at an inappropriate level.	A CLO that develops one part of a broad PO is Aligned. Coverage of the whole PO is checked separately, across the curriculum.
B. Coverage	A CLO is aligned only when it addresses every part of the PO: each action, object and condition. A CLO that develops some parts is partially aligned.	A CLO that develops one part of a broad PO is Partially aligned. Coverage of the whole PO is shown CLO by CLO.
C. Contribution, with a recorded degree	As A, and each CLO–PO mapping also records how far the CLO develops the PO, for example introductory, enabling or demonstrating.	A CLO that develops one part of a broad PO is Aligned, with its degree recorded. Coverage is checked across the curriculum from the recorded degrees, which needs an agreed scale.
D. Other	The panel's own wording.	As the panel describes.

An illustration (not one of the review cases): a CLO on preparing a project budget, mapped to a PO on planning, implementing and evaluating projects, is Aligned under A and C and Partially aligned under B. Where a CLO implies a component without stating it, the answer can also depend on whether implied components count.

What the system holds (evidence of current practice, with its status; not policy)

- **One template maps a CLO to POs whose wording it does not contain** (status: transcribed). The IT 204 syllabus template copied into the system maps its CLO "Design, implement, and test robust and maintainable Java programs …" to PO 3 ("Design and develop computing solutions using a system-level perspective.") and to PO 7 ("Understand the impact of their work on society and strive to ensure that their actions contribute positively on the community."). The CLO's wording does not mention society. The system does not record why these mappings were made, and some of the template's tags (PO 11, PO 14) are not in the BSIT list.

- **The template's CLOs carry level labels that the system does not define:** Introductory, Enabling, Demonstrating and Integration of Values (decision I7).
- **No curriculum map is held**, so the system has no record of how far each course contributes to each PO.

Cases affected: 9. The coordinator holds the list and shares it with the panel after the case reviewers have returned Part A.

Status: open; requires an institutional decision.

Decision record	
Decision (option, with any wording)	
Rationale	
Decided by (role)	
Approval reference (minutes, memo or resolution)	
Date	
Applies to (programs)	

P2. When is an ILO aligned with its CLO: when it develops part of the CLO, or only when it addresses all of it?

The same question as P1, one level down: it concerns one ILO and the CLO it is linked to.

Option	What it says	What it would mean in practice
A. Partial development	An ILO is aligned when it develops part of its CLO, in the same subject, even if it does not address the CLO's other parts.	An ILO that develops one part of its CLO is Aligned. Whether the ILOs linked to a CLO together cover it is not part of this verdict.
B. Coverage	An ILO is aligned only when it addresses every part of its CLO; otherwise it is partially aligned.	An ILO that develops one part of its CLO is Partially aligned.
C. Partial development, with the set checked	As A, and the ILOs linked to each CLO are checked together to confirm that they cover it.	An ILO that develops one part of its CLO is Aligned, and each CLO's set of ILOs is checked as well.
D. Other	The panel's own wording.	As the panel describes.

Related sub-questions

- (a) How should an ILO at a lower cognitive level than its CLO be judged?
- (b) How should an ILO at a higher cognitive level than its CLO be judged?
- (c) Must an ILO state its CLO's context or qualities, for example its setting, a required quality, or the conditions of performance?

What the system holds (evidence of current practice, with its status; not policy)

- Each ILO is linked to one CLO. No institutional rule on how an ILO is judged against its CLO is held.

Cases affected: 11. The coordinator holds the list and shares it with the panel after the case reviewers have returned Part A.

Status: open; requires an institutional decision.

Decision record	
Decision (option, with any wording)	
Rationale	
Decided by (role)	
Approval reference (minutes, memo or resolution)	
Date	
Applies to (programs)	

P3. How is a CLO judged against an expected graduate attribute that is held only as a name?

The four attributes are held only as names (R-EGA; status: transcribed): "Critical and Creative thinker", "Competent Catholic Augustinian-Marian Professional", "Socially Responsive Steward", "Transformative Lifelong learner".

Option	What it says	What it would mean in practice
A. As a whole	A CLO aligns with an attribute when it develops the attribute in a recognisable way. It need not reflect every element of the name.	A CLO can align with an attribute without showing every element of its name.
B. Element by element	The CLO must reflect each element of the name. For example, for "Critical and Creative thinker" it must show both critical and creative thinking; for "Competent Catholic Augustinian-Marian Professional", both professional competence and the Catholic and Augustinian-Marian dimension.	A CLO aligns with an attribute only if it shows every element of the name.
C. Against an institutional description	The institution supplies a description or rubric for each attribute, and CLOs are judged against it.	CLOs are judged against the descriptions once they are supplied (decision I3).
D. Other	The panel's own wording.	As the panel describes.

Related sub-questions

- (a) Can a technical CLO with no ethical or faith element align with "Competent Catholic Augustinian-Marian Professional"?
- (b) Must a CLO mapped to "Critical and Creative thinker" show creativity as well as critical thinking?
- (c) Is a CLO's link to "Socially Responsive Steward" established by serving a community need?

What the system holds (evidence of current practice, with its status; not policy)

- **Names only** (status: transcribed); no description of any attribute is held. The system also records that the source syllabi state no PO-to-EGA mapping for BSIE and BSCpE.
- **The BSIT list maps each PO to attributes** (status: transcribed; the mapping is not confirmed). The PO texts are in R-BSIT. It shows how one program's list associates outcomes with attributes. It is not a definition of the attributes.

Attribute	BSIT POs mapped to it in the system's list
1 (Critical and Creative thinker)	1, 2, 3, 8
2 (Competent Catholic Augustinian-Marian Professional)	4, 5, 9

Attribute	BSIT POs mapped to it in the system's list
3 (Socially Responsive Steward)	7, 10
4 (Transformative Lifelong learner)	6, 8

Cases affected: 7. The coordinator holds the list and shares it with the panel after the case reviewers have returned Part A.

Status: open; requires an institutional decision. If an official description of each attribute exists, please supply it (decision I3).

Decision record	
Decision (option, with any wording)	
Rationale	
Decided by (role)	
Approval reference (minutes, memo or resolution)	
Date	
Applies to (programs)	

P4. Should an outcome's fit with its course affect the alignment verdict?

Situations: a CLO on a topic that the curriculum teaches in another course; a team design CLO without the course's subject content; a CLO whose activity the course description does not mention; a CLO that may be too advanced, or too basic, for its year.

Option	What it says	What it would mean in practice
A. Separate	The alignment verdict judges only the relationship between the two outcomes. Fit with the course's subject and year level is a separate finding.	Two findings are reported. An outcome can be Aligned and also be found not to fit its course.
B. Integrated	An outcome outside the course's subject cannot be aligned, whatever its relationship to the PO or EGA.	One finding is reported. An outcome outside the course's subject is not aligned.
C. Integrated only across disciplines	An outcome from another discipline altogether is not aligned; otherwise fit is a separate finding.	One finding for an outcome from another discipline; two findings otherwise.
D. Other	The panel's own wording.	As the panel describes.

Related sub-questions

- (a) What is the authority on a course's scope: the course description, the approved syllabus or the curriculum?
- (b) Does the institution set expected cognitive levels by year?
- (c) Who decides that an outcome is too advanced or too basic for its year?

What the system holds (evidence of current practice, with its status; not policy)

- **Registrar curriculum transcriptions** for BS Information Technology; BS Industrial Engineering; BS Computer Engineering; BS Information Technology with Specialization in Cyber Security (status: transcribed; not confirmed by the registrar), with year, semester, units and prerequisites (R-BSIT, R-BSIE). They show where courses sit, not how fit should affect an alignment verdict.
- **No year-level policy is held.** Nothing at all is held for BSN, BSEd, BSA or BSHM.

Cases affected: 10. The coordinator holds the list and shares it with the panel after the case reviewers have returned Part A.

Status: open; requires an institutional decision.

Decision record	
Decision (option, with any wording)	
Rationale	
Decided by (role)	
Approval reference (minutes, memo or resolution)	
Date	
Applies to (programs)	

P5. When a recommendation concerns a mapping, should it re-map or rewrite, and what must it state?

Situations: a sound CLO mapped to an unrelated PO or EGA; an ILO linked to the wrong CLO; a CLO that fits no outcome of its program; a CLO that is weak in itself.

Sub-questions (tick one option in each, or write your own):

(a) When an outcome is sound but mapped to the wrong outcome:

- ☐ Change the mapping and keep the text
- ☐ Rewrite the text to fit the mapping
- ☐ Decide case by case
- ☐ Other: _____

(b) Must a re-mapping recommendation name the outcome to map to?

- ☐ Yes, always
- ☐ Yes, when the program's list is available
- ☐ No, stating that the mapping does not fit is enough
- ☐ Other: _____

(c) May a recommendation propose removing an outcome from its course?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No, only flag it
- ☐ Other: _____

(d) Who approves a mapping change? (name the role) _____

(e) When an outcome is below its course's level and mapped to the wrong outcome, should it be:

- ☐ Re-mapped as it is
- ☐ Rewritten first
- ☐ Decided case by case
- ☐ Other: _____

What the system holds (evidence of current practice, with its status; not policy)

- In the system as designed, the institution's vision, mission and EGAs, and each program's POs, are fixed. Faculty write CLOs and map them.
- When the IT 204 template was copied, its tags to PO 11 and PO 14, which are not in the BSIT list, were left out so that "an administrator decides what they should map to". That is how one mapping question was handled, not a rule.

Cases affected: 14. The coordinator holds the list and shares it with the panel after the case reviewers have returned Part A.

Status: open; requires an institutional decision.

Decision record	
Decision (option, with any wording)	
Rationale	
Decided by (role)	
Approval reference (minutes, memo or resolution)	
Date	
Applies to (programs)	

P6. May a recommendation add or change value wording in an outcome, and which value vocabulary applies?

Sub-questions

- (a) When a CLO already names values, may a recommendation add other values, or attribute them to a tradition (for example call a value "Marian" or "Augustinian")?
- (b) Which vocabulary is authoritative for syllabus outcomes: the six core values; values described as Augustinian or Marian; other terms (for example integrity, truth, service)?
- (c) Must recommendations keep the author's value wording exactly?
- (d) Who confirms that the value wording in an outcome is correct?

What the system holds (evidence of current practice, with its status; not policy)

- **Six core values** (status: website copy, pending approval): Compassion, Courage, Community-orientedness, Humility, Interiority, Missionary Spirit. Their names and definitions were copied from the university website and have not been confirmed for syllabus checking (R-VAL, decision I4).
- **No tradition is assigned.** No source in the system assigns any value to an Augustinian or a Marian tradition.
- **One template uses the phrase** (status: transcribed). The IT 204 template uses "Christo-centric Catholic and Marian–Augustinian values" in a CLO.

Cases affected: 2. The coordinator holds the list and shares it with the panel after the case reviewers have returned Part A.

Status: open; requires an institutional decision. It also needs the value definitions to be confirmed (decision I4).

Decision record	
Decision (option, with any wording)	
Rationale	
Decided by (role)	
Approval reference (minutes, memo or resolution)	
Date	
Applies to (programs)	

P7. How are cognitive (Bloom's) levels applied to graduate attributes and to outcomes with several verbs?

Sub-questions

- (a) Should an EGA, which is a noun phrase rather than an action, be given a cognitive level? If not, how is a CLO's level judged against it?
- (b) When an outcome has several verbs (for example "design, implement and evaluate"), which verb sets its level: the highest, the main one, or each separately?
- (c) How should an ILO's level be compared with its CLO's? (See also P2.)
- (d) Which taxonomy and verb list does the institution use?

What the system holds (evidence of current practice, with its status; not policy)

- **Levels are used in practice** (status: transcribed). The IT 204 template's CLO titles name levels: "Skill Development / Evaluate", "Application / Create", "Ethics & Responsibility / Evaluate & Create".
- **No rule is held** on how levels are assigned or compared.

Cases affected: 8. The coordinator holds the list and shares it with the panel after the case reviewers have returned Part A.

Status: open; requires an institutional decision.

Decision record	
Decision (option, with any wording)	
Rationale	
Decided by (role)	
Approval reference (minutes, memo or resolution)	
Date	
Applies to (programs)	